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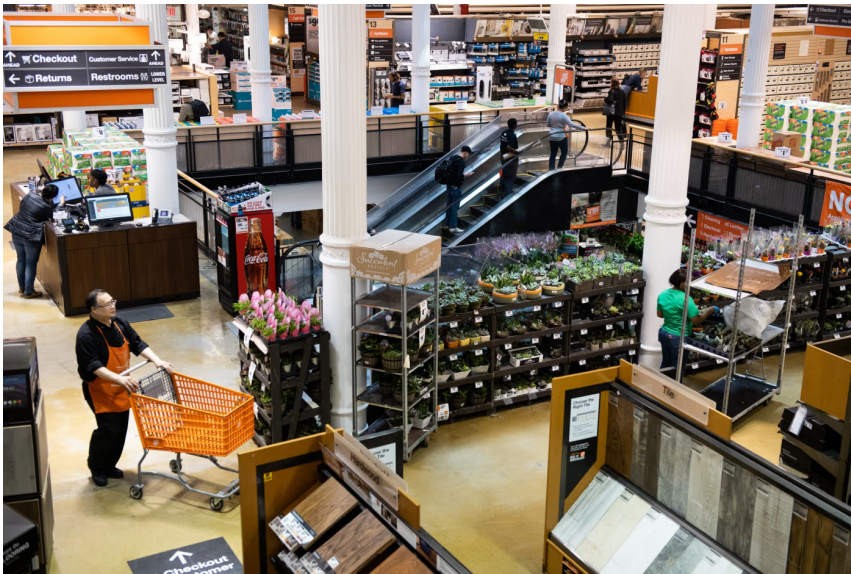
NEWSPLUS

Home Depot Revenue Falls Short of Expectations

Revenue of \$24.95 billion was below the consensus forecast of \$25.15 billion

By Allison Prang

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Home Depot said it expects sales to increase by about 6.7% for the year. Revenue in the first quarter missed analysts' forecasts. MARK KAUZLARICH/BLOOMBERG NEWS

Home Depot Inc. (HD) released its first-quarter financial results before the market opened Tuesday. Here's what you need to know.

PROFIT: The home-improvement retailer made \$2.4 billion, or \$2.08 a share, up 19% from the \$2.01 billion, or \$1.67 a share, it made during the same quarter a year ago.

REVENUE: Net sales rose 4.4% to \$24.95 billion. Analysts polled by Thomson Reuters were expecting revenue of \$25.15 billion. Cost of sales rose 3.8% to \$16.33 billion.

SAME-STORE SALES: Home Depot said comparable-store sales rose 4.2% and U.S.

comparable-store sales rose 3.9%. Analysts polled by Consensus Metrix were expecting same-store sales to rise by 5.6% and U.S. same-store sales to rise by 5.5%.

EXPENSES: Total operating expenses rose 9% to \$5.24 billion.

GUIDANCE: The company said it expects sales to increase by about 6.7% for the year. In the company's fourth-quarter earnings results, it said it expected sales for 2018, including the 53rd week, to rise by about 6.5%. Home Depot said in its latest earnings report it expects comparable-sales in 2018 to rise by about 5%.

Shares fell 2.1% premarket. In the past 12 months, they've climbed 21%.

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Allison Prang formerly covered breaking news for The Wall Street Journal in New York. Before joining the Journal, she was a reporter for American Banker, where she wrote about community banks. She was previously a business reporter for the Post and Courier in Charleston, S.C. Allison graduated from the University of Missouri where she...

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